

PERSONAL CONNECTION: NOT MY FAULT

Many streets in Los Angeles are ridiculously narrow and hardly leave room for cars to pass one another. A few years ago, I was driving on one of these roads with three friends in the car when a VW bus came roaring down the street and showed no intention of slowing down or sharing the road. I pulled over as far as I could and came to a complete stop. The VW torpedo continued on its seek-and-destroy mission, scraped the side of my car, and ripped my bumper off.

The driver hopped out of his bus and looked like he wanted to kill me for getting in the way of his luxury cruiser. Meanwhile, his van was still resting up against my car with my bumper hanging out of its mouth. A woman then came out of her house to reveal that she was the driver's wife, and that she and the reckless driver lived right in front of the scene of the accident. When she asked what happened, we told her that her husband came flying down the street and ripped my bumper off. (Weirdly, the husband said nothing through this whole process. I suspect he may have grown up in the woods, never learning to drive or speak.) She argued that my story was preposterous because he would never be driving fast enough to rip off a bumper when he was right in front of his house. Did I mention that my bumper was hanging off the guy's van? I argued with the wife and the silent husband for a while before realizing we would have to settle this through our insurance.

After we submitted our reports of the accident, I was still found partially liable (at fault). Although I was at a complete stop on the side of the road, it was decided that I was at least partially to blame. My insurance policy covered the repairs, but the next time I received my monthly insurance bill, I learned that my